

It is essential to check performance for consistency and find any gaps as early as possible in the deployment phase. AI systems usually work on proportionate outcomes, and some variation at the solution level is already accepted. When you couple this inherent variation with the variation of several humans and other systems, it can quickly become unmanageable. Although each variation might have been acceptable independently, when combined, it can be problematic and result in poor overall performance.

That's the reason why performance must be checked for these gaps once you deploy the AI solution. When you use your AI solution, several systems interacting with your AI solution may go haywire. If you didn't plan for systematic changes before the deployment, it could soon become a roadblock.

Performing Gauge R&R (Gauge Repeatability and Reproducibility) tests can reveal several actionable findings. It is a statistical test used to identify variance between multiple operators and can be used to test how various users interact with the same system. You can also use it to check how multiple systems interact with your AI solution.

The outcome of Gauge R&R studies gives you an indication of the causes of variation in the performance. These findings can help in formulating training plans for fixing user performance. These can also help you in formulating system change requirements to make them work seamlessly.

Continuously monitoring the user and system interactions and periodically conducting systematic checks (and tests) can help you in managing incorrect usage of your AI solution.

## Handling user testing and feedback

No matter how much content you put into training material, it is not always possible to cover all the questions users may have. It makes it essential to establish easy to use and quickly

accessible communication channel between users and responding team.

If you can make it clear who the contact person is, how long it will take to get a response and how to escalate, if needed, it would help in gaining users' confidence and give them clarity about AI deployments. By doing this, you will only encourage users to come to you when they encounter any issues.

Giving them confidence that their feedback is valuable, and you will always take it on board can go a long way. Moreover, once received, do not just consume the feedback but act on it.

Sincerely checking every feedback and fine-tuning your AI application can help in improving users' experience. It can give them confidence in the deployed AI system. Doing this also reduces the number of bad and incompetent users significantly and thereby reduces your overall risk exposure quickly.

## Augmenting HR teams

Until now, HR teams have been carrying out responsibilities to manage the performance of the (human) workforce. This is now changing as machines are becoming smarter, and AI is becoming mainstream. So, how do you plan to handle this new type of workforce, which is fully automatic (AI only) or is augmented by smart machines (humans+AI)?

HR teams will have to manage performance gaps and issues related to system malfunctions as well as retraining requirements of humans and machines. If there is any impact on human performance due to poor-quality AI systems, it will have to be handled differently than how they would handle typical human (only) performance improvement.

Generally speaking, AI systems are smart, but they seriously lack the key characteristic of humans, common sense! With the deployment of digital twins of your human employees, it may become an essential requirement.

Humans in charge of powerful technologies would have to be trained, coached, and managed effectively.

It would be a good idea to take steps towards establishing a new HAIR (Human and AI Resources) team or augment the existing HR team and accommodate these new challenges. The development of appropriate policies and procedures must be core to their initial tasks.

## Start looking beyond the technology

No matter how smart the technology or AI in particular is, it cannot apply common sense and human perspective.

Therefore, merely nailing the technical element of AI is not enough; you need to balance it with the human aspect. The understanding of the surrounding environment in which you are using AI is crucial.

Technology teams need to demonstrate cognitive intelligence if they want to be successful. As much as the development and deployment of an AI solution are critical, the user aspect is important too. Without proper use (and users), AI success will surely hang by a thread.

A good AI solution in the hands of bad users can be disastrous, while an average AI solution in the hands of good users can be a great success. The users have the full power to make or break it; your goal should be to enable your users and extract maximum positive value out of it. **END** 🐧

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